

CRAB RAVIOLI WITH CRAB SAUCE

SERVES
4

TOTAL TIME
3 h

INGREDIENTS

250 g	Pasta Dough — 00 flour
1	Pasta Dough — egg (whole)
6	Pasta Dough — egg yolks (reserve 2 for egg wash)
1 tbsp	Pasta Dough — olive oil
1 tbsp	Pasta Dough — cold water
1 pinch	Pasta Dough — salt
3	Crab Meat — large cock crabs (or 1kg white + 300g brown)
6 l	Crab Meat — water
100 g	Crab Meat — salt
3	Crab Meat — lemons, juiced
1 sprig	Crab Meat — thyme
1	Crab Meat — bay leaf
200 g	Salmon Mousse — smoked salmon
200 g	Salmon Mousse — sole (or other white fish)
1	Salmon Mousse — egg white
600 ml	Salmon Mousse — double cream
to taste	Salmon Mousse — salt and pepper
3 kg	Crab Sauce — crab shells (from cooked crabs)
250 ml	Crab Sauce — brandy
50 g each	Crab Sauce — onion, carrots, fennel, leek, celery (sliced)
100 g	Crab Sauce — tomatoes
20 g	Crab Sauce — garlic
1 g	Crab Sauce — saffron threads
100 ml	Crab Sauce — Pernod
500 ml	Crab Sauce — white wine
10 g each	Crab Sauce — thyme, rosemary
20 g	Crab Sauce — parsley
500 ml	Crab Sauce — double cream
150 g	Crab Sauce — butter

METHOD

1. Prepare the crabs: Combine water, lemon juice, salt, thyme and bay leaf in a large pan. Bring to boil, add crabs and simmer for 10 minutes. Cooking time depends on crab size. Once cooked, cool and pick all meat - keep white and brown separate. Reserve shells for stock.
2. Make pasta dough: Place flour in a bowl, make a well in centre. Pour in eggs, olive oil, water and salt. Gradually bring flour in from edges until dough forms. Turn onto table and knead 4-5 minutes until smooth. Cover and rest in fridge for minimum 1 hour.
3. Prepare salmon mousse: Remove skin and bone from fish, cut into chunks. Blend with egg white until smooth paste. Pass through fine sieve. Place over ice, slowly stir in cream, salt and pepper. Check consistency by poaching a spoonful - don't let water boil. Continue adding cream until right texture.
4. Make filling: Combine 1kg white crab meat with 300g brown meat and 200g salmon mousse. Add herbs, lemon juice and seasoning. Mix well and chill.
5. Prepare crab sauce: Break shells into small pieces, roast at 180°C for 10 minutes. Deglaze with brandy (careful - it will ignite). Sauté vegetables, add shells, tomatoes, wine, Pernod and aromatics. Cover with water and simmer 1 hour. Strain, reduce, finish with cream, butter, lemon juice, Tabasco. Season to taste.
6. Form ravioli: Roll pasta to second thinnest setting on machine. Weigh filling into 50g balls. Place on pasta sheet, egg wash around filling, cover with another sheet. Cut with 6cm pastry cutter. Press around filling to seal, removing all air. Store on tray.
7. Cook and serve: Bring 2 litres salted water to boil. Cook ravioli for 4 minutes. Meanwhile, bring sauce to boil, add butter and brown crab meat, blend to achieve bubbles. Blanch samphire 30 seconds. Place samphire in bowls, arrange ravioli on top, add tomato concasse, spoon sauce over. Finish with brown crab meat, olive oil, fleur de sel and chervil leaves.

NOTES

This elaborate crab ravioli recipe makes a tremendous main course, especially apt for spring and summer months. The dish features a complex crab filling with salmon mousse, enclosed in delicate homemade pasta, and served with an intensely flavorful crab sauce made from roasted shells.

Chef's Tips: The key to this dish is timing - prepare all components in advance and cook the ravioli to order. The brown crab meat adds intense flavor to both the filling and the sauce. Don't skip the fresh herbs - they brighten the rich crab flavors.

FILLING

Crab and Salmon Mousse Filling

INGREDIENTS

3	Crab meat — large cock crabs (or 1 kg white + 300 g brown)
6 l	Crab meat — water
100 g	Crab meat — salt
3	Crab meat — lemons, juiced
1 sprig	Crab meat — thyme
1	Crab meat — bay leaf
200 g	Salmon mousse — smoked salmon
200 g	Salmon mousse — sole (or other white fish)
1	Salmon mousse — egg white
600 ml	Salmon mousse — double cream
to taste	Salmon mousse — salt and pepper
1 kg	Final mix — white crab meat
300 g	Final mix — brown crab meat
200 g	Final mix — salmon mousse
quantity not given	Final mix — herbs, lemon juice and seasoning

METHOD

1. Bring the water, lemon juice, salt, thyme and bay leaf to the boil, drop in the crabs and simmer 10 minutes. Bigger crabs take longer.
2. Cool the crabs and pick all the meat, keeping white and brown apart. Keep the shells.
3. Skin and bone the sole and smoked salmon, cut into chunks, blend with the egg white to a smooth paste, then push through a fine sieve.
4. Set the paste over ice and stir in the cream slowly with salt and pepper.
5. Test the texture by poaching a spoonful in water held below a boil, and keep adding cream until it is right.
6. Fold 1 kg white crab meat, 300 g brown meat and 200 g of the mousse together, then season with herbs, lemon juice, salt and pepper.
7. Mix well and chill.

NOTES

Two sub-components: picked crab meat and a separate salmon mousse. Only 200 g of the mousse goes into the filling, and the mousse quantities as written make far more than that. The source does not say what to do with the surplus.

The herbs in the final mix are never named.

Shells from cooking the crabs go to the crab sauce, and brown crab meat is also used in that sauce and as a garnish. Both are outside this file.

Portioned at 50 g per raviolo, cut with a 6 cm cutter.

SHAPE

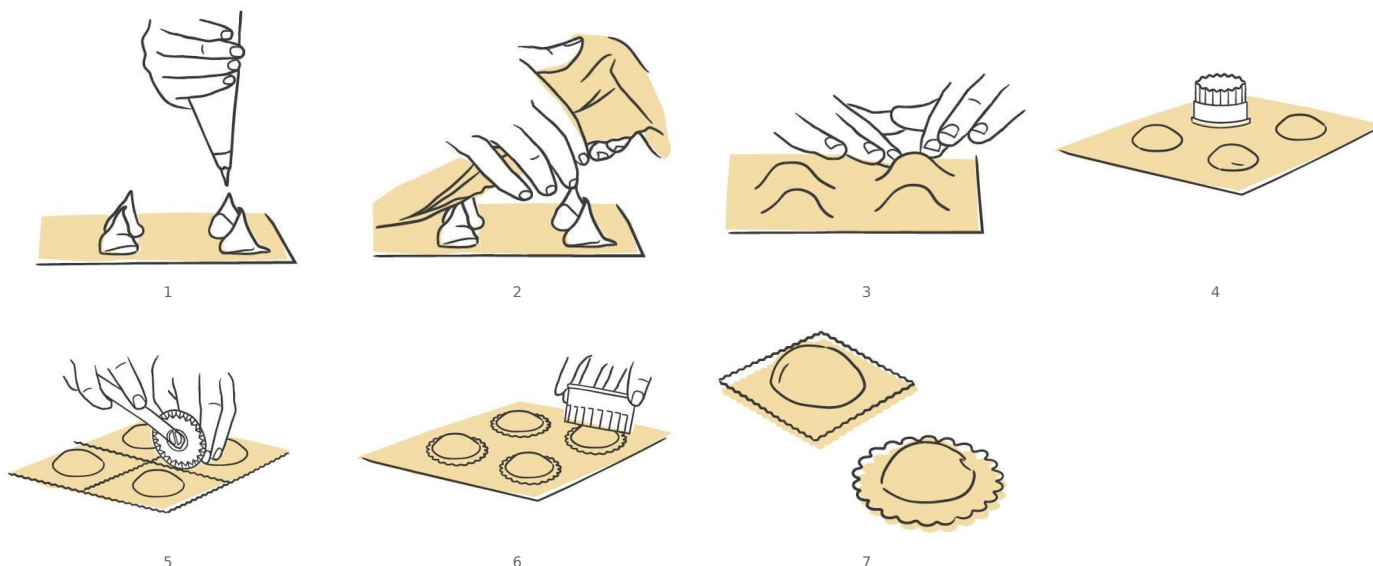
Ravioli

Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.

Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.

Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.

Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.

Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.

Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.

The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.

Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.

Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____
